sales programmes to both India and Pakistan.

Shastri's greatest achievement was the Indo–Pak War of 1965, which, partly helped boost the morale of the army that had been shattered by the border war with China in 1962. Unfortunately, Shastri passed away with a massive heart attack soon after signing the Tashkent Agreement. In January 1966, Indira Gandhi became the first woman Prime Minister of independent India.

Indira Gandhi (1966–1977) and (1980–1984)

When Indira Gandhi came to power, India was grappling with hard times during 1966–1969. The troubles had arisen in the aftermath of border war with China and these increased with two years of severe drought accompanied by flooding in other parts of the country which had grave impact on the economy of the country and also constrained India's assertiveness and capacity to take initiatives in international relations and on her policy of non-alignment.

Soon after Indira Gandhi assumed the office, she expressed her solidarity and moral support to the principles of non-alignment. Tito and Nasser arranged a meeting with her and she visited UAR and Yugoslavia in July 1966. The Third Tripartite Conference of the leaders of UAR, Yugoslavia and India was held in New Delhi in October 1966. The proceedings of these meetings and the joint communiqué reflected the concern of Mrs. Gandhi and others over the imposition of various forms of imperialism and neo-colonialism and the threat to world peace posed by gross interference in the internal affairs of independent countries followed by economic and financial assistance as an instrument of pressure. The three, Gandhi, Tito and Nasser, also expressed their deep concern for the sufferings of the Vietnamese people and demanded a cessation of the bombing of North Vietnam. This was rather a courageous stand taken by Mrs. Gandhi as the economic crisis had made India heavily dependent on the United States.

Mrs. Gandhi visited the United States from 28 March to 1 April 1966 and agreements on US aid followed one after another in the coming years in the fields of supply of fertilizers, mineral exploration and a food agreement in which Washington undertook to supply 3.5 million